Prepared BY:
Wodi diepreye emmanuel

WODI DIEPREYE EMMANUEL
(Dear-Preye)

THE 4-STEP MESSAGE SYSTEM

HOW NIGERIAN BRANDS CAN WRITE SALES MESSAGES

WODI-DIEPREYE.VERCEL.APP

Introduction

The other day I was going through WhatsApp statuses and I just kept seeing the same thing.

Same product, same caption, same energy, over and over again.

And I did not buy from any of them. Not because I didn't need what they were selling, I probably did. I just could not find one reason to choose one over the other. They all looked the same, they all said the same thing, and none of them made me feel anything.

That is problem number one, everybody is doing what everybody else is doing.

But here is the one that actually costs money. The few brands that do stand out visually still lose sales because their message is not doing its job. It describes the product but it does not move the person reading it, and there is a difference.

A good sales message does one thing, it takes someone from "that looks nice" to "let me send this person money right now." That shift does not happen by luck, it happens because of how the message is built.

I put together four steps that make that shift happen. I use them and they work.

Here is how they go.

The 4-step message system

STEP 1 - EXPOSE

Start with a feeling your audience already knows, not a fact about your product but a feeling about their situation. Make them feel like you have been watching.

EXAMPLE:

> *"When you order food and it doesn't meet your expectations, it doesn't just hurt your taste buds, it hurts your wallet too."*

STEP 2 - CAST

Show them a better reality, something specific enough to feel real. Not a dream but a possibility they can actually see themselves in.

EXAMPLE:

> *"What everyone wants is to order a meal and actually enjoy it, no disappointment, no regret, just good food."*

STEP 3 - HOLD

This is where most people rush, so slow down here. Make them feel seen and not sold to. Speak to the private hope they have not said out loud.

EXAMPLE:

> *"I'm sure you've hoped it could be you, that you could order anytime and still get the best quality every single time."*

STEP 4 - OFFER

Now give them the next step, keep it simple and make it one thing with no pressure. The sale happens here because everything before it has already done the work.

EXAMPLE:

> *"You can have that, all it takes is trusting us once."*

THE TEMPLATES

TEMPLATE 1 - FOOD VENDOR

Fill in the blank

"YOU ORDERED [PRODUCT] AND WHEN IT ARRIVED IT WAS [DISAPPOINTMENT], AND THE PERSON THAT SOLD IT TO YOU [POOR SERVICE].

THAT IS NOT JUST A BAD PURCHASE, THAT IS [EMOTIONAL CONSEQUENCE].

ALL YOU REALLY WANT IS TO ORDER [PRODUCT] AND ACTUALLY ENJOY IT, NO [FEAR 1], NO [FEAR 2].

WE KNOW THAT FEELING, AND THAT IS EXACTLY WHY WE DO WHAT WE DO. TRY US ONCE, [SIMPLE NEXT STEP]."

Worked Example

"YOU ORDERED JOLLOF RICE, PAID GOOD MONEY, AND WAITED. THEN IT ARRIVED AND THE FIRST BITE TOLD YOU EVERYTHING, IT WAS NOT WORTH IT.

THAT IS NOT JUST HUNGER, THAT IS THE FRUSTRATION OF TRUSTING SOMEONE WITH YOUR MONEY AND YOUR STOMACH AND GETTING LET DOWN BY BOTH.

EVERY NIGERIAN JUST WANTS ONE THING, TO ORDER FOOD AND EAT WITHOUT REGRET, TO CLOSE YOUR EYES AT THE FIRST BITE AND KNOW YOUR MONEY WENT SOMEWHERE GOOD.

THAT IS WHAT WE MAKE HAPPEN, EVERY ORDER, EVERY TIME. ALL YOU HAVE TO DO IS TRY US ONCE."

TEMPLATE 2 - FASHION BRAND

Fill in the blank

"YOU ORDERED [PRODUCT], PAID FOR IT, AND WAITED. WHEN IT FINALLY ARRIVED THE [DISAPPOINTMENT 1] WAS WRONG, THE [DISAPPOINTMENT 2] WAS OFF, AND WHEN YOU TRIED TO COMPLAIN THE SELLER [POOR SERVICE].

THAT IS NOT JUST A BAD PURCHASE, THAT IS [EMOTION 1] YOU DID NOT ASK FOR, [EMOTION 2] FROM TRUSTING THE WRONG PERSON WITH YOUR MONEY, AND THE QUIET [EMOTION 3] OF KNOWING YOU CANNOT EVEN WEAR WHAT YOU PAID FOR.

ALL YOU WANT IS TO ORDER SOMETHING AND HAVE IT ARRIVE EXACTLY THE WAY IT LOOKED, RIGHT [QUALITY 1], RIGHT [QUALITY 2], FROM SOMEONE WHO ACTUALLY [SERVICE PROMISE].

YOU HAVE WAITED LONG ENOUGH FOR THAT, IT IS TIME TO ORDER FROM US."

Worked Example

YOU ORDERED AN OUTFIT, PAID FOR IT, AND WAITED. WHEN IT ARRIVED THE FABRIC WAS WRONG, THE FITTING WAS OFF, AND WHEN YOU TRIED TO REACH THE SELLER THEY LEFT YOU ON READ.

THAT IS NOT JUST A BAD PURCHASE, THAT IS ANGER YOU DID NOT ASK FOR, PAIN FROM TRUSTING THE WRONG PERSON WITH YOUR MONEY, AND THE QUIET SADNESS OF KNOWING YOU CANNOT EVEN WEAR WHAT YOU PAID FOR.

ALL YOU WANT IS TO PLACE AN ORDER AND HAVE IT ARRIVE EXACTLY THE WAY IT LOOKED, RIGHT FABRIC, RIGHT FITTING, FROM SOMEONE WHO ACTUALLY PICKS UP WHEN YOU CALL.

YOU HAVE WAITED LONG ENOUGH FOR THAT, IT IS TIME TO ORDER FROM US."

TEMPLATE 3 - PERFUME BRAND

Fill in the blank

"YOU SAW [PRODUCT], THE VENDOR SEEMED CONVINCING AND THE PRICE FELT FAIR, SO YOU BOUGHT IT. AND THE MOMENT YOU [USED IT] YOU KNEW SOMETHING WAS OFF, IT DID NOT [PERSONAL FIT 1], IT DID NOT [PERSONAL FIT 2], IT JUST [NEGATIVE EXPERIENCE] LIKE A MISTAKE YOU PAID FOR.

THAT IS NOT JUST A BAD PURCHASE, THAT IS WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU TAKE A CHANCE ON THE WRONG PERSON, AGAIN.

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY WANT IS A SCENT THAT FEELS LIKE IT WAS MADE FOR YOU, SOMETHING THAT [DESIRED EXPERIENCE], NOT SOMETHING THAT [FAILURE].

YOU DO NOT HAVE TO KEEP GUESSING, [RISK REVERSAL], JUST [SIMPLE FIRST STEP] AND LET US DO THE REST."

Worked Example

"YOU SAW A PERFUME, THE VENDOR WAS CONVINCING AND THE PRICE SEEMED FAIR, SO YOU BOUGHT IT. AND THE MOMENT YOU SPRAYED IT YOU KNEW SOMETHING WAS WRONG, IT DID NOT SMELL LIKE YOU, IT DID NOT FEEL LIKE YOU, IT JUST SAT ON YOUR SKIN LIKE A MISTAKE YOU PAID FOR.

THAT IS NOT JUST A BAD PURCHASE, THAT IS WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU TAKE A CHANCE ON THE WRONG PERSON, AGAIN.

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY WANT IS A SCENT THAT FEELS LIKE IT WAS MADE FOR YOU, SOMETHING THAT MAKES PEOPLE NOTICE WHEN YOU WALK INTO A ROOM, NOT SOMETHING THAT FADES IN AN HOUR AND LEAVES NOTHING BEHIND.

YOU DO NOT HAVE TO KEEP GAMBLING WITH YOUR MONEY, WE WILL FIND YOUR SCENT BEFORE YOU SPEND ANYTHING, JUST SEND US A MESSAGE FIRST."

THE CHECKLIST

Before you post any sales message, ask yourself these five questions.

1. Does my opening describe a feeling my audience already knows, not a feature of my product?
2. Have I shown them a better reality that actually feels reachable?
3. Have I made them feel seen, or have I just described what I am selling?
4. Is my call to action one simple step, or am I asking them to do too many things at once?
5. If I were my own customer, would this message move me?

If you answer no to any of these, go back to the step that is missing.

ONE LAST THING

My name is Wodi Diepreye.

I help Nigerian brands write messages that actually convert, not just content that looks good but copy that moves real people from interest to payment.

If you read this guide and you are wondering what your own message should sound like, that is exactly what the free consultation is for.

We look at what you are currently saying, find where it is losing people, and fix it
together.

It is one conversation, it is free, and it might be the most useful thirty minutes you put into your business this month.

BOOK A FREE CONSULTATION

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